

Segment 17 – Little Presque Isle Point to Echo Lake Rd

(Formerly Segment #16), updated April 2024 [Google Map of Segment 17](#) The Google Map is only for an overview of the trail. **Use Avenza Maps for actually locating and following the trail.**

Trail Adopters: Laura Sabo & Joe Cavitt, 906-251-0507, laurasabo58@gmail.com

Segment length: About 3.3 miles, east to west 68 ft of ascent, 48 ft of descent

Link to [Avenza Maps Online](#) Use Map # 42 in the Avenza app. Make sure you have the current updates for Avenza. Always refer to the updated Avenza Maps for the most current NCT mile markers.

Please contact the Trail Crew Leader (Bob Weisenberger, 906 361-4033, rweisenber@gmail.com) or the Trail Adopter above with reports of trail conditions, including blowdowns, washouts or inadequate blazing, or if you have questions on driving directions to the start point.

Many of the backroads have multiple names depending on which map you are using. When known, multiple names for the same road have been indicated in italics within brackets.

On the trail: (for this segment, the trail description will be westbound, follow in reverse for eastbound.)

The segment begins at Little Presque Isle Point (46.634721,-87.464521) just east of the Little Presque Isle parking area. The trail shares a path with the Little Songbird Trail and is a great hike for bird watching along the shores of Lake Superior.

The NCT travels along Lake Superior for about 1.75 miles then heads south towards CR 550. You'll cross a boardwalk constructed by Northern Michigan University students in 2022. Cross CR 550 and follow the path west to reach Echo Lake Rd (46.643965,-87.506107).

Driving Directions:

Eastern Trailhead

From the corner of Hawley St./Lakeshore Boulevard in Marquette, head west for 6.5 miles on Hawley St., which turns into [County Road (CR) 550/Big Bay Rd]. Watch for the signs for "Little Presque Isle Recreation Area, Day Use Area". (Do not turn at the one that says "Wetmore Landing Day Use Area".) Turn right and follow the two track for .5 miles to the parking area. A short trail at the end of the parking lot heads to the promontory where you pick up the NCT.

Western Trailhead

From the corner of Hawley St./Lakeshore Boulevard in Marquette, head west for about 8.7 miles on Hawley St., which turns into [County Road (CR) 550/Big Bay Rd] to Echo Lake Rd (an unsigned two track). The segment is about .1 miles to the west down Echo Lake Rd (46.643965,-87.506107). Parking is available on an old road area just east of CR 510 (46.645563,-87.504286)

Camping:

Michigan DNR rents rustic cabins near Little Presque Isle and Harlow Lake, although they are not right on the trail. [MIDNR Little Presque Isle Cabins](#) Dispersed camping is not allowed on this segment.

Water Access:

This segment has public access to Lake Superior.

Seasonal Access Information:

The main road is drivable year-round. A [Michigan Recreation Passport](#) is required to park at the eastern trailhead. The road into Little Presque Isle parking is challenging/impossible in the wintertime. A parking lot is usually plowed at [Wintertime parking](#) on the west side of [CR 550/Big Bay Rd].

For the western trailhead, the parking is sometimes plowed in the wintertime. Your wintertime parking option may be along CR 550, which is a busy road.